David Gareth Werren (Known as Gareth)

Engineering Leader | AI-Enabled Development & Engineering Excellence | Financial Services

Summary

Engineering leader and software architect with 19 years in financial services technology across lending, pensions, and trading and risk. I have led engineering functions of up to 30 people across the UK, Portugal, Hungary and India, improving delivery quality and throughput by working with the team to set standards for code review, testing, CI/CD and documentation.

I currently lead AI adoption across the software delivery lifecycle, from AI-assisted coding and test generation to AI-powered pull request reviews and production systems monitoring. I combine hands-on experience with a track record of winning board-level support through clear, evidence-based proposals.

Key Achievements

AI Transformation: Led the adoption of Claude Code and GitHub Copilot across the engineering team through champions, usage showcases and experimentation time, continually improving the team-wide AI tooling through internal MCP servers, shared skill definitions and knowledge. We have an estimated 2x-10x increase in delivery capacity (depending on the type of task) whilst maintaining quality.

Board-level influence: Persuaded the Bluestone Group board to invest in building a new origination platform instead of enhancing the existing home-grown system, modelling and presenting cost, timeline and risk for each option side by side. That platform is now Origin, Fignum's flagship product which is live with multiple lenders.

Shared platform architecture: Architected Evolve, the core platform that powers both loan origination (Origin) and loan servicing (Adapt). That architecture now underpins our rapid prototyping and delivery of bespoke client solutions.

Global team leadership: Built and led a team of teams across multiple products, totalling around 30 engineers and testers across the UK, Portugal and Hungary, delivering multi-million-pound programmes whilst supporting existing systems.

Skills

Engineering leadership: Engineering standards • Testing strategy • Branching strategy • Developer experience • Stakeholder management & influence • Distributed teams

AI-enabled development: Claude Code • GitHub Copilot • AI adoption • Testing • Documentation

Technology: C# • SQL • Distributed Systems • Kafka • Kubernetes • GitHub • Azure DevOps

Financial services: Lending (mortgage and motor) • Pensions • Trading and risk

Experience

Head of Development / Chief Platform Officer, Fignum, Cambridge — Jan 2020 – Current

Fignum is a fintech startup that has grown out of the Bluestone Group's internal software and IT services, providing highly configurable loan origination and servicing platforms to specialist lenders.

AI-Enabled Engineering

- Led adoption of AI across the software delivery lifecycle. Claude Code for development, test generation (automated and manual testing) and documentation. GitHub Copilot for PR review. Custom tooling including MCP servers and monitoring and triage tools to enhance AI capabilities.
- Drove adoption through a champions network (including myself), AI showcase sessions across the wider business, shared custom tooling, and dedicated experimentation time.
- Continuous review of the impact of using AI, both the benefits and the negative impacts, catching issues early and driving increasingly larger benefits.
- Defined AI product capabilities within Origin and Adapt, combining build (full in-product agentic capabilities) and buy (e.g. bank statement data extraction) solutions.

Architecture and Delivery

- Architected Evolve, the shared platform underpinning two products:
    - Origin: A configurable loan origination system for multi-asset lending including mortgage and motor, with 30+ third-party integrations. Currently live with multiple clients.
    - Adapt: A configurable loan servicing system with a double-entry finance engine, collections workflow system and bank reconciliation capabilities.
- Architected Paycada, an SME payments platform integrating with Xero and Stripe, sharing many components from the Evolve platform.
- Built and led a team of teams across Evolve, Paycada and existing production systems, totalling around 30 engineers and testers across the UK, Portugal and Hungary.
- Managed a suite of legacy in-house products including card payments and telephony systems, focusing on service quality, compliance and support.

Engineering Standards and Developer Experience

- Shaped the design of Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines for automated build, test and deployment alongside the branching strategy, with GitHub for source control and code review. Evolving the design as our needs changed, ensuring we can quickly and confidently make and release changes.
- Set standards across the development lifecycle, focusing on code and testing quality and developer experience, ensuring continual delivery of high-quality systems with developers having confidence in the changes they make.

Lead Developer, River and Mercantile Solutions, London — Nov 2014 – Jan 2020

River and Mercantile Solutions (now Schroders Solutions) provided fiduciary and advisory services to pension funds.

- Provided technical leadership across the team of 9 in-house developers alongside leading the implementation of automated build, test and deployment solutions
- Designed and built trade modelling systems for securities and currency hedging, with complex user interfaces
- Designed and built an online portal for clients to access up-to-date scheme information and as a platform for our consultants to use in client meetings

Software Engineer, Base 4, Cambridge — Aug 2012 – Nov 2014

Base 4 was a small biotech company developing brand new systems for DNA sequencing.

- Designed and built high-performance lab control and data capture systems, reducing the time taken to run experiments from days to hours and increasing the quality of data captured
- Designed and built data analysis software to reduce and streamline manual effort

Software Developer, SunGard Adaptiv, Cambridge — Jan 2007 – Jul 2012

SunGard's Adaptiv (now part of FIS) provided market and credit risk solutions to the financial sector.

- Grew from building the initial POC for a brand-new enterprise product (Adaptiv Risk Cube) to being the lead architect, leading client POCs and implementations, and managing a team

Education — 2001 - 2005

University of Bristol: Master of Engineering (Joint Honours: Computer Science, Electrical Engineering, Engineering Maths)